TASK 5

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention

Cybercrime has increased significantly in recent years. Today, people are exposed to different types of online threats like phishing, UPI frauds, Identity theft, and so on.

The Scenario: The "Identity Theft" Trap

Here is a case study of Harish, who was a first-year engineering student. He was very fond of creating blogs and talking about his experiences online. One day, Harish's parents who lived in another city, got a call from an unknown number. When they picked up the call, they saw that it was Harish and he was in a very desperate state, asking for emergency help. The parents panicked and they did whatever Harish was telling them to do. So they did send money to some account as told. However, when they called up Harish, he said no, there was nothing of that sort and then they realized that they have been a victim of identity theft.

Identity theft is a cybercrime in which an attacker steals a person’s personal information, and uses it for fraudulent activities.

How it typically happens (Step-by-Step):

1. A student unknowingly shares personal details, images or videos online
2. The attacker collects sensitive information such as phone number, email ID, students face and voice
3. Using this data, the attacker logs into the student’s bank account, email, or social media profiles.
4. He may create fake accounts or impersonate and request money from contacts

The stolen identity is then used for financial fraud, scams, or illegal activities.